

DAY 12 / 30

THE FORGE · PRACTICAL GENAI

Zero-shot vs few-shot prompting

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One of the highest-leverage prompt engineering tricks costs you two extra sentences: showing an example.

- ◆ Zero-shot prompting: you ask for a task with no examples, relying purely on the model's general training. "Classify this review as positive or negative." Works fine for simple, common tasks.
- ◆ Few-shot prompting: you include a couple of example input/output pairs before your real request. Suddenly the model has a concrete pattern to match, not just an abstract instruction — and quality jumps, especially for tasks with a specific format, tone, or edge cases that are hard to describe in words.

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“Have you tried few-shot prompting, or have you mostly been doing zero-shot without realizing it had a name?”

Follow along – Day 13 drops tomorrow.

#PromptEngineering

#AI

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